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MEETING NOTES

RE: Austin Comprehensive Plan
Planning Advisory Committee Meeting #2

Date of Meeting: November 13, 2024

Project Manager: Mark Nolan

Time of Meeting: 5:00 to 7:00 P.M.

SEH No.: 180253

Location of Meeting: Austin Public Library

The following items were discussed at the above-referenced meeting (see attached presentation for additional reference):

- Introductions
- Comp Plan Elements
 - The committee was given an overview of the chapters/core elements of a comprehensive plan
 - The structure of a comprehensive plan (i.e. engagement – vision - chapter goals - strategies) was reviewed
- Schedule and Milestones
 - Overall project/PAC schedule was reviewed, as well as what has been accomplished thus far (including the work by the Velocity Group)
- Public Input – Phase 1
 - Engagement efforts for the comprehensive plan was reviewed
 - Engagement thus far:
 - Over 120 events
 - Over 1,200 participants
 - 84 online mapping comments
 - 393 online survey participants
 - Online Survey #1 results were presented
 - Comment from PAC member: Does 400 participants seem low to everyone?
 - Response from PAC member: I would say compared to other communities, this seems to be consistent with typical response rates. Even the City of Minneapolis had similar response percentage for their comprehensive plan.
 - Response from PAC member: The project team has been putting in the work to create a strong network and partnerships that will be beneficial for the next round of engagement. We are aiming to tap those networks and get the word out even more, especially to those residents who don't go to a formal meeting.
 - Response from team: We are going to rely on you to help us promote the project and the next survey.
 - Assets
 - Comment from PAC member: The community really highlighted that they find the small-town feel and character as one of the top things they like of Austin. So how do we continue to grow and make improvements without erasing that character? As we move forward, it will be important for the city to be intentional in planning to preserve that feeling.

- Issues or Barriers
 - Comment from PAC member: I find it interesting that the high school building was brought up because I have received this question before from multiple people. I would be interested in knowing more about how much the city spends on maintaining the building and if it is time to consider finding a new space or constructing a new building? Is the old building getting in the way of the education that is being provided to the students?
 - Response from PAC member: Perhaps we can find a way to repurpose the building instead of tearing it down. In the past the city has torn down old buildings and we have lost all that history and character. I would love to see us find ways to preserve these buildings and have a mix of old historic buildings and modern ones.
- Opportunities for improvements
 - Comment from PAC member: I am glad people highlighted more sidewalks. I have been a strong advocate to improving walking and biking infrastructure in our community. But in the past, there have been many times where a sidewalk is being proposed for an existing neighborhood. The residents who live on the neighborhood oppose the sidewalk and they end up not being built.
- Visioning Activity (see attached)
 - Project team facilitated activity to help construct a visioning statement
 - PAC members shared their responses of what they feel Austin will be like, what it will offer its residents, and how it will be is connected
- Next Steps
 - Demographics and Growth Projections
 - Survey #2
 - Base Mapping
 - Schedule Open House #1
 - PAC Meeting Topics and Schedule
 - Continue to Spread the Word!

If changes or additions are needed in this document, or if relevant information has been omitted, please contact Project Manager, Mark Nolan at mnolan@sehinc.com.